

Master Prompt — RepoSkins Free Kit

Cards · contribution snake · social badges. One prompt, four phases.

Read this first.

This prompt drives a coding assistant through the RepoSkins Master Kit — a template engine, not a generative one. Two people running this against the same GitHub username get the exact same cards, pixel for pixel, because the kit renders real templates against real data rather than inventing anything. What varies is your data: your name, your avatar, your contribution graph, your stars. The value of the prompt is in the checkpoints — creating the profile repo the wrong way, or publishing the snake with a workflow that clobbers other content, are both silent failures that don't show up until later.

You need:

a coding assistant with shell access (or just a terminal), Python 3.10+, the `gh` CLI, and a GitHub account. Budget 10–15 minutes including the first Actions run.

▼ THE PROMPT — copy everything below to "END OF PROMPT" ▼

I want to set up my animated GitHub profile using the RepoSkins Master Kit (github.com/leonardoborgesdev/reposkins). Walk me through it step by step, and check in with me after each phase before moving on.

My details

- GitHub username: [USERNAME] (profile repo will be [USERNAME]/[USERNAME], branch main)
- Theme: midnight or github-dark - I choose: [THEME]
- Cards I want: [e.g. hero,wordmark,heatmap,portrait,chess,system-scan,highlights,social-row]
- My social links for badges (optional): [e.g. linkedin:https://..., instagram:https://..., email:me@example.com]

PHASE 1 - Authenticate

Run "gh auth status". If I'm not logged in, walk me through "gh auth login". Then export the token: "export GITHUB_TOKEN=\$(gh auth token)". Without this the heatmap card comes back empty and I'll hit the public API's 60 req/hour limit fast.

PHASE 2 - Generate

Run "python generate.py [USERNAME] --theme [THEME] --cards [CARDS] --with-snake --badges "[BADGES]" ". Show me the generated SVGs - open them, don't just tell me it worked - before we go further.

PHASE 3 - The special repo

Remind me the repo must be named exactly [USERNAME]/[USERNAME] and created through GitHub's web UI, not the API, with "Add a README file" checked. A repo created via API sometimes fails to trigger the special profile display. This is the step people skip and then ask why nothing shows up.

PHASE 4 - Publish

Help me copy assets/ into the repo root, copy github-actions/snake-[THEME].yaml to .github/workflows/snake.yaml, copy README.generated.md into README.md, commit, push.

Before the snake works: remind me to set Settings > Actions > General > Workflow permissions > Read and write on the REPOSITORY (not my account), and to run the workflow once manually - the output branch doesn't exist until that first run finishes green. If I already publish something else to the output branch, confirm the workflow publishes additively (worktree + targeted commit) rather than replacing the whole branch.

How to work with me

- Verify by opening the file, not by trusting the command's exit code. A 0 exit code means the script ran, not that the SVG looks right.
- When I say something "didn't change," check the raw file first with a cache-busting ?v=999 query string before touching any code.

It's almost always GitHub's cache, not a bug.

- Tell me when I'm wrong. If a step won't work the way I described it, say so instead of trying it anyway.
- If I reject something twice, stop and ask rather than trying a third variation.

END OF PROMPT

What to expect

Phase	Effort	Iteration?
1 — Authenticate	2 min	No
2 — Generate	3 min	Maybe — re-run with different cards or theme
3 — Special repo	2 min	No, but easy to get wrong once
4 — Publish + snake	5–10 min	No — the only wait is the first Action run

Phases 2–4 are copy-paste and could be done without any assistant at all — the prompt exists so you get one continuous session instead of switching between a document and a terminal.

Known issues

Issue	Status
Wordmark card uses a plain large-text render, not the original product's proportional block-letter ASCII font	Visually simpler but fully functional; a full font reconstruction is in progress
<code>about</code> , <code>stats</code> , <code>stack</code> cards only theme correctly in <code>midnight</code>	Excluded from the free kit rather than shipped half-themed
Snake dot colors are hand-picked per theme, not derived automatically from the palette	Fine for the 2 shipped themes; would need a real mapping function to scale further

Approaches that were tried and dropped

- **Guessing the live product's API URL pattern to auto-extract more theme templates.** Every guessed path either 404'd or returned the site's JS app shell instead of an SVG. Reliable template extraction requires actually driving a browser against the real UI and capturing the rendered request — there's no shortcut through URL pattern-matching.
- **A clean gh-pages-style deploy action for publishing the snake.** The first version of the snake workflow used an action that force-replaces the entire target branch on every run. On a profile that already published something else to that same branch (a generated GIF, in one real case), this would have silently deleted it on the very first run. Replaced with an additive worktree-based publish before shipping.
- **Hosting the generator behind one shared backend.** Works, but ties every user's rate limit and uptime to the same server and the same GitHub token. The whole point of this kit is the opposite: your token, your machine, your repo.

The core tradeoff.

Pixel-perfect fidelity to a theme requires a real template, hand-extracted from the live product by actually using its UI once. That work doesn't scale by writing more code — it scales by spending more hands-on time per theme. That's the honest reason this kit ships exactly 2 themes instead of all 21: those are the two someone actually sat down and extracted properly. Everything else in the kit (the data fetching, the card layout logic, the snake workflow, the badges) is free to extend yourself — the repo is MIT licensed.

If you only want the snake and badges — skip most of this document. Those two phases need no card generation at all; the workflow and `badges.py` in the repo work standalone.

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